BAYZICKS

The Digital Careers Field Guide

Every major path into digital work — freelancing, marketing, sales, tech, and more — broken into Roles, Skills, Tools, a Learning Path, and Job Opportunities.

The digital world, made simple.

How to use this guide

You don't need to read this cover to cover. Skim the career paths below, and when one makes you think “wait, that actually sounds like me” — stop there. Read that page properly. Every path is broken into the same five parts, so once you know how to read one, you know how to read all of them:

ROLES	The actual job titles you'd be searching for or aiming toward.
SKILLS	The beginner-friendly skills worth building first — not everything, just what matters early.
TOOLS	The software people in this field actually use day to day, most of it free to start.
LEARNING PATH	A realistic step-by-step order to learn in, so you're not guessing what to do first.
JOB OPPORTUNITIES	Where this kind of work actually shows up: freelance, full-time, or both — and where to look.

None of these paths need a computer science degree or a wall of certifications to start. They need one honest first step. This guide is here to help you find it.

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12. No-Code Automation & Systems Building
13. E-commerce Support
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Freelancing & Service-Based Work

The starting point for most people getting into digital work: selling a skill you already have, directly, to clients online.

ROLES

- Freelance generalist (multi-skill)
- Specialist freelancer (one core service)
- Productized service provider (fixed-scope packages)

SKILLS

- Picking one clear, sellable skill to start with
- Writing a simple offer that says what you do and for whom
- Basic client communication and scope-setting
- Pricing your first few projects without underselling

TOOLS

- Upwork, Fiverr, or Contra for finding first clients
- Google Docs / Notion for proposals and scope docs
- Wise or PayPal for getting paid internationally
- Calendly for booking discovery calls

LEARNING PATH

- Pick one skill you can already do reasonably well
- Create 2-3 sample pieces of work if you have no portfolio yet
- Set up one profile on a freelance platform and one direct outreach channel
- Take your first paid project even if the price is low, to build proof

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance: found via marketplaces (Upwork, Fiverr) or direct outreach (LinkedIn, cold email)
- Freelance-to-agency: many freelancers get pulled into small agencies as they grow
- Salary range varies widely by skill and experience; expect lower rates on your first 3-5 projects

Virtual Assistance

Supporting a business owner or executive remotely with the day-to-day tasks that keep things running.

ROLES

- General Virtual Assistant (VA)
- Executive Assistant (EA)
- Social Media VA
- E-commerce / Operations VA

SKILLS

- Calendar and inbox management
- Basic use of spreadsheets and project boards
- Clear written communication across time zones
- Following a process without needing constant supervision

TOOLS

- Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Calendar)
- Notion or Trello for task tracking
- Slack or Discord for team communication
- Canva for basic content support

LEARNING PATH

- Learn the core tools above through free tutorials (1-2 weeks)
- Offer to VA for a friend's small business or a low-stakes project first
- Build a simple one-page resume focused on organization and responsiveness
- Apply to VA-specific job boards and freelance platforms

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance/contract: most common entry point, hourly or retainer-based
- Full-time remote VA roles exist with growing small businesses
- Found on: Belay, Fancy Hands, Upwork, VA-specific Facebook groups and job boards

Digital Marketing

Helping brands get seen and get customers online — covers social media, SEO, content, and paid advertising.

ROLES

- Social Media Manager
- SEO Specialist
- Content Marketer
- Paid Ads / Performance Marketer
- Email Marketing Specialist

SKILLS

- Understanding a target audience and what makes them click
- Basic copywriting for ads, captions, and emails
- Reading simple performance metrics (clicks, conversions, engagement)
- Consistency: showing up on a content or posting schedule

TOOLS

- Meta Business Suite, Canva, CapCut for social content
- Google Analytics and Google Search Console for SEO basics
- Mailchimp or ConvertKit for email marketing
- Meta Ads Manager or Google Ads for paid campaigns

LEARNING PATH

- Pick one lane first (social, SEO, or email) rather than all at once
- Run a free or low-cost campaign for your own page or a friend's small business
- Learn to read basic metrics and explain what they mean in plain language
- Package results into a simple case study to show future clients or employers

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance: managing social/email/SEO for small businesses on retainer
- In-house: marketing roles at startups and small-to-mid companies
- Agency: entry-level roles at digital marketing agencies
- Found on: LinkedIn, agency job boards, direct outreach to small business owners

Copywriting & Content Creation

Turning ideas into words and content that get people to read, trust, and buy.

ROLES

- Copywriter (ads, sales pages, emails)
- Content Writer (blogs, articles)
- Scriptwriter (video, podcast)
- Ghostwriter (for founders and creators)

SKILLS

- Writing clearly and persuasively for a specific audience
- Understanding basic structures: hooks, headlines, calls to action
- Editing your own work down to the essentials
- Adapting tone across brands and platforms

TOOLS

- Google Docs for drafting and collaboration
- Grammarly or Hemingway for editing
- Notion for organizing client work and swipe files
- ChatGPT or Claude as a drafting and research aid, not a replacement for your voice

LEARNING PATH

- Study 10-15 examples of great copy in a niche you like
- Write 3-5 sample pieces (ad, email, landing page) as a starter portfolio
- Offer a discounted or free first project in exchange for a testimonial
- Specialize in one industry or format once you find what you enjoy

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance: direct clients, agencies, or marketplaces (Contra, Upwork)
- In-house: content or copywriting roles at startups and marketing teams
- Found on: LinkedIn, freelance platforms, cold pitching founders directly

Tech Sales (SDR, BDR & Deal Closing)

Helping software and tech companies find, qualify, and close new customers — one of the highest-demand entry points into tech without needing to code.

ROLES

- Sales Development Rep (SDR)
- Business Development Rep (BDR)
- Account Executive (AE) / Closer
- Customer Success Manager (post-sale)

SKILLS

- Cold outreach: email, LinkedIn, and call scripts
- Qualifying a lead (figuring out if they're a real fit)
- Objection handling and confident, non-pushy conversation
- Basic CRM hygiene: logging calls, notes, and next steps

TOOLS

- A CRM such as HubSpot or Salesforce
- LinkedIn Sales Navigator for prospecting
- Loom for quick video outreach and demos
- Calendly for booking sales calls

LEARNING PATH

- Learn the basics of a CRM and the SDR-to-AE career path
- Practice a cold outreach script out loud until it sounds natural
- Apply specifically for entry-level SDR/BDR roles, which are built for beginners
- Aim to move from SDR to closing (AE) within 12-18 months of strong performance

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: SDR/BDR roles are widely hired as entry points at tech and SaaS companies
- Freelance/contract: some companies hire contract closers on commission
- Found on: LinkedIn Jobs, company career pages, tech-specific job boards

Customer Success & Support

Helping customers actually get value from a product — a common, beginner-friendly door into tech companies.

ROLES

- Customer Support Representative
- Customer Success Manager (CSM)
- Technical Support Specialist
- Community Manager

SKILLS

- Patient, clear written and verbal communication
- Troubleshooting: asking the right questions to find the real problem
- Basic familiarity with help-desk software
- Staying calm with frustrated customers

TOOLS

- Zendesk or Intercom for support tickets
- Notion or a knowledge base for documentation
- Slack for internal team communication
- A CRM for tracking customer accounts (for CSM roles)

LEARNING PATH

- Get comfortable with one help-desk tool through free tutorials
- Practice writing calm, clear responses to common complaint scenarios
- Apply to entry-level support roles, which rarely require prior experience
- Move toward CSM or team-lead roles as you build a track record

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time and contract roles are both common, including remote-first companies
- Found on: company career pages, remote job boards, LinkedIn Jobs

Data Analysis

Turning raw numbers into decisions — useful across marketing, sales, product, and operations.

ROLES

- Data Analyst
- Marketing Analyst
- Business Intelligence (BI) Analyst
- Reporting / Insights Specialist

SKILLS

- Spreadsheet fluency (formulas, pivot tables)
- Basic SQL for pulling data from databases
- Turning numbers into a clear story or recommendation
- Data visualization: building charts people can actually read

TOOLS

- Excel or Google Sheets
- SQL (start with free courses on SQLBolt or similar)
- Looker Studio or Power BI for dashboards
- Python (optional, for more advanced analysis later)

LEARNING PATH

- Master spreadsheets first before touching SQL or Python
- Learn basic SQL through free interactive courses
- Practice on public datasets and build 2-3 sample dashboards
- Apply to junior analyst roles or offer analysis as a freelance add-on service

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: junior/analyst roles across nearly every industry
- Freelance: reporting and dashboard-building for small businesses
- Found on: LinkedIn Jobs, general job boards, referrals through business owners you already support

Cybersecurity

Protecting systems, data, and people from digital threats — a growing field with real beginner on-ramps, not just deep technical roles.

ROLES

- Security Analyst (entry-level SOC)
- IT Support with security focus
- GRC (Governance, Risk & Compliance) Associate
- Penetration Tester (more advanced)

SKILLS

- Basic networking and how the internet actually works
- Understanding common threats: phishing, malware, social engineering
- Following security checklists and compliance frameworks
- Comfort with troubleshooting and structured problem-solving

TOOLS

- CompTIA Security+ study materials (a common starting certification)
- A home lab (free virtual machines) for practice
- Basic command-line familiarity (Linux/Windows)
- Wireshark, for observing network traffic (learning tool)

LEARNING PATH

- Start with a foundational IT or networking course before jumping to security
- Study toward an entry-level certification like CompTIA Security+
- Practice in free labs (TryHackMe, Hack The Box beginner tracks)
- Apply to entry-level SOC analyst or IT-security-hybrid roles

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: entry-level SOC and IT-security roles at companies of all sizes
- Government and compliance-heavy industries hire steadily for GRC roles
- Found on: LinkedIn Jobs, cybersecurity-specific job boards, certification-provider job boards

UX / Product Design

Designing digital products so they're actually usable — and, ideally, enjoyable.

ROLES

- UX/UI Designer
- Product Designer
- UX Researcher
- Visual/Brand Designer

SKILLS

- Understanding user problems before jumping to solutions
- Wireframing and prototyping
- Basic visual design principles: layout, color, typography
- Giving and receiving design feedback

TOOLS

- Figma (industry standard, free tier available)
- Canva for simpler visual work
- Maze or UsabilityHub for basic user testing
- Notion for documenting research and decisions

LEARNING PATH

- Learn Figma through free tutorials (a few weeks of consistent practice)
- Redesign 2-3 existing apps or websites as practice projects
- Build a simple portfolio showing your process, not just final screens
- Apply to junior design roles or take on small freelance projects

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: junior/associate designer roles at startups and product companies
- Freelance: logo, website, and app design projects for small businesses
- Found on: Dribbble, LinkedIn Jobs, design-specific job boards

Software Development & Web Development

Building the websites, apps, and systems that everything else runs on.

ROLES

- Front-End Developer
- Back-End Developer
- Full-Stack Developer
- No-Code / Low-Code Developer

SKILLS

- Problem-solving and breaking big tasks into small steps
- One programming language, learned deeply, before adding more
- Reading documentation and error messages without panicking
- Version control basics (Git)

TOOLS

- VS Code as your main editor
- GitHub for version control and portfolio projects
- freeCodeCamp or The Odin Project for structured free learning
- Webflow or Bubble, if going the no-code route instead

LEARNING PATH

- Pick one path: traditional coding or no-code, based on your timeline and interest
- Complete one structured free curriculum start to finish
- Build 3-5 real projects, not just tutorial follow-alongs
- Apply to junior roles or take freelance projects to build real-world experience

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: junior developer roles, though often competitive without a portfolio
- Freelance: building websites and simple apps for small businesses
- Found on: LinkedIn Jobs, AngelList/Wellfound, GitHub Jobs, direct outreach

Project Management (Remote & Digital Teams)

Keeping remote teams and projects organized, on schedule, and actually shipping.

ROLES

- Project Coordinator
- Project Manager
- Scrum Master / Agile Coach
- Operations Manager

SKILLS

- Breaking a project into clear tasks and deadlines
- Running a simple, effective meeting
- Basic understanding of project frameworks (Agile, Kanban)
- Keeping people accountable without micromanaging

TOOLS

- Asana, Trello, or ClickUp for task management
- Notion for documentation and processes
- Slack or Google Meet for team communication
- Google Sheets for basic timelines and budgets

LEARNING PATH

- Learn one project management framework (Agile/Kanban basics) for free online
- Volunteer to coordinate a small project (even outside work) as practice
- Get comfortable with one project management tool end-to-end
- Apply to coordinator-level roles as your entry point before PM titles

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Full-time: coordinator and junior PM roles across most industries
- Freelance/fractional: operations support for small businesses and startups
- Found on: LinkedIn Jobs, general job boards, referrals from freelance clients

No-Code Automation & Systems Building

A genuinely underrated skill: helping businesses automate repetitive work using no-code tools — no coding required, and far less crowded than social media or copywriting.

ROLES

- Automation Specialist / Consultant
- Systems Builder (Notion, Airtable, CRM setup)
- Operations Consultant for small businesses

SKILLS

- Mapping out a business's repetitive manual tasks
- Connecting apps together so they talk to each other automatically
- Basic logic: if this happens, then do that
- Explaining technical setups in plain language to non-technical clients

TOOLS

- Zapier or Make.com for connecting apps
- Notion or Airtable for building simple internal systems
- A CRM such as HubSpot for sales/client automations
- ChatGPT or Claude for drafting automation logic and documentation

LEARNING PATH

- Pick one tool (Zapier or Make) and complete its free beginner course
- Automate one repetitive task in your own life or a friend's business as practice
- Document the before/after as a simple case study
- Offer a small "automation audit" as your first paid service

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance: this is almost entirely a freelance/consulting service right now
- In-house: growing companies increasingly hire "Ops" or "RevOps" roles that include automation
- Found on: direct outreach to small business owners, Upwork, no-code community job boards (Makerpad, Zapier community)

E-commerce Support

Helping online sellers actually run their stores — from Amazon operations to storefront setup — a steady, less glamorous corner of digital work with real demand.

ROLES

- Amazon PPC Specialist
- FBA (Fulfillment by Amazon) Operations Assistant
- E-commerce Store Manager (Shopify/Etsy)
- Product Listing & Launch Specialist

SKILLS

- Understanding how Amazon/Shopify listings, ads, and rankings work
- Basic ad campaign setup and budget monitoring
- Inventory and fulfillment coordination
- Writing clear, conversion-focused product listings

TOOLS

- Amazon Seller Central and Amazon Ads Manager
- Shopify or Etsy seller dashboards
- Helium 10 or Jungle Scout for product/keyword research
- Google Sheets for inventory and ad performance tracking

LEARNING PATH

- Learn how Amazon Seller Central and PPC campaigns work through free official resources
- Study 2-3 successful product listings to understand what makes them convert
- Offer to help manage or launch one small seller's listing as a starter project
- Specialize in either PPC/ads or operations/fulfillment as you grow

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Freelance/contract: most e-commerce support work is contract-based, per store or per launch
- Full-time: growing e-commerce brands hire in-house support and PPC specialists
- Found on: Upwork, e-commerce-specific Facebook groups, direct outreach to Amazon/Shopify sellers

Course Creation

Helping people package what they already know into a course they can sell — a skill in itself, separate from being the expert being taught.

ROLES

- Course Creator (for yourself)
- Course Builder / Producer (for other experts)
- Instructional Designer
- Cohort/Community Course Facilitator

SKILLS

- Breaking expert knowledge down into a clear, learnable structure
- Basic video recording and editing
- Choosing the right format (self-paced vs. live cohort)
- Simple sales page and launch copywriting

TOOLS

- Teachable, Kajabi, or Podia for hosting and selling a course
- Loom or CapCut for recording and light editing
- Notion for outlining course structure and curriculum
- Canva for slides and course visuals

LEARNING PATH

- Pick one specific outcome the course will deliver, not a broad topic
- Outline the course structure before recording anything
- Record a short pilot module and get feedback from 2-3 people in your target audience
- Launch a simple version first, then improve it based on real learner feedback

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

- Self-employed: creating and selling your own course is the most common path
- Freelance/contract: helping other experts build and produce their course
- Found on: direct outreach to creators and coaches, referrals, course-platform partner directories

Found your path?

Bayzicks offers free coaching, a free 30-minute consultation, and a free community if you want a real person to help you take the next step from here.

bayzicks.com